

Flashing Java

For all your efforts to make a classy Web site with Flash effects, it's possible that someone may be accessing it with a browser sans a Flash player. Hence, keep an alternative link that lets people bypass such effects. It is unreasonable to expect people to download an extra plug-in just to view the information on your Web site, especially when they can find the same elsewhere.

Keep the same in mind while opting for Flash menus. While the eye-candy is pleasing, with slow Internet access, people would prefer to have a no-

fuss access to information. The same argument goes for using Java applets on your Web site. It's possible that Net-surfers may not have the Java Runtime Environment (JRE) installed. Downloading it from the Internet takes quite a while. Hence, keep a non-Java version too, and display a visible link to it.

Frames

Frames may make your Web



Here's a site with reasonable frames, which allow for easy navigation through the site

Standards of Access

The various accessibility standards ensure that the Internet and the World Wide Web is accessible to all, irrespective of the surfer's mode of access or disabilities. There are two well-known standards and guidelines of accessibility. The first is the World Wide Web Consortium (W3C) standard called the Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG), under their Web Accessibility Initiative (<http://www.w3.org/WAI/>). These guidelines have three levels of specification that provide various priority levels. The other is the US Government's Section 508 guidelines (www.section508.gov), which look at a relatively lesser level of accessibility guidelines, concentrating mostly on basic accessibility, whilst leaving out many other pressing issues. Both services offer free accessibility testing services and tools.



Get this mascot to grace your Web site once you pass the Bobby test

Bobby is a free service that tests Web sites for ease of use, adherence to standards and accessibility by people with disabilities. Display their endearing mascot on your Web site once it's Bobby-tested successfully.

pages look organised and neat, but they can be quite a hassle for those using a browser that does not support them. Hence, keep a link to a version of your Web site sans frames. This ensures access to all, regardless of frame compatibility.

Here's what you can do. After '</FRAMESET>', write '<NOFRAMES></NOFRAMES>', and include the HTML code that you would want to display in a frame-disabled browser within these two tags.

Testing

Testing each page on all the possible browsers makes a lot of sense, as if your pages are not in strict conformance of the W3C standards, then your complex pages appear differently in different browsers. Ensure that your HTML toolkit has several popular browsers, namely, Opera, Netscape and Mozilla. Also, consider testing the page with the Lynx text browser.

Checking and validating

It doesn't take too much effort to have your Web pages tested and validated. With little effort, you can use freely available services and tools over the Internet that will validate your Web pages and Web sites.

W3C's check

The W3C Web site (www.w3c.org) offers you free HTML and Cascading Style Sheets (CSS) validation services. Access the free HTML validation service at <http://validator.w3.org/>. It checks and ensures that your HTML code follows the W3C's Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG). Either submit the URL, or upload an HTML file for inspection. Access the tweakable features for this service by clicking on 'Extended Interface' or 'Extended File Upload Interface' on the home page. Alternatively, gain access to them at <http://validator.w3.org/>



W3C's site offers a free validation check. Just enter the URL to get the page validated

detailed.html for a submitted URL, or <http://validator.w3.org/file-upload.html> for an uploaded file. W3C's service depends on Document Type Definition (DTD) to validate the code. Lack of a proper DTD would lead to non-validation of the page.

Validating the page CSS

Visit the W3C CSS validation service (<http://jigsaw.w3.org/css-validator/>), and choose to either validate by giving the URL of the CSS, or uploading



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Security

www.zdnetindia.com/security